

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 10 2
 ♥ 9 8 7 4 3
 ♦ 10 9
 ♣ 8 5 4

♠ A K 7 6 4

♥ A J 10

♦ 8

♣ K Q J 7



♠ J 3

♥ K 6 5 2

♦ K Q J 5 2

♣ 6 3

♠ 9 8 5

♥ Q

♦ A 7 6 4 3

♣ A 10 9 2

West	North	East	South
	1♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

6♠ by North

Win the ♦A in dummy. Play the ♥Q to the ♥A and ruff the ♥10 with dummy's ♠8. Play the ♠5 to your ♠A and ruff the ♥J with dummy's ♠9.

Return to your hand with a ♣ and pull another round of trumps with your ♠K. Leaving the master trump out start playing ♣ winners. Someone may ruff with their master trump but that's the only trick they will get.

It was very bold to bid this slam and South/North were fortunate to find a distribution where it could be made.

But that would have been all for nothing if North had not found the PLAN to make it.

You open 1♠ and partner jumps to 3♠.

Wow. It looks like you might have a great fit. You bid 4NT and partner responds 5♥.

Partner shows 2 Aces so you bid 6♠.

North plays 6♠. East leads the ♦K.

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Losers: ♠ 1? : ♥ 1 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 0 : Total = 2?

If trumps don't split 3-2 you will definitely go down 1, so assume they do split. You could finesse West once in ♥s, or use a ruffing finesse on East, but the cleanest approach is just to ruff two ♥s in dummy. Of course you must do this before you pull trumps.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 7 6 4
♥ K 8
♦ A 10 6 2
♣ A Q 3

♠ Q J 10 8

♥ 6 5 3

♦ Q 5 4

♣ J 7 4



♠ K 5

♥ A 9 4

♦ K 9 8 7 3

♣ K 10 5

♠ A 3 2

♥ Q J 10 7 2

♦ J

♣ 9 8 6 2

With 13 points and 4 of partner's minor suit you may be tempted to say 2NT or 3♦. Both these temptations should be resisted - your first obligation is to show a 4-card Major if you have one. As poor as the suit is, you still respond 1♠.

Partner comes back with 1NT. (Hint: don't rebid the ♠s.)

Partner has 13/14 points and a balanced hand. You have 13 points and a balanced hand. How about 3NT?

West	North	East	South
1♠	Pass	1♦	Pass
3NT	Pass	1NT	Pass
All Pass			

3NT by East

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♥Q.

West would play 3NT.

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East plays 3NT. South leads the ♥Q.

Winner count: ♠ 0 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 3 : Total = 7

You need two more winners and you can almost surely get them in ♦s. In fact, if the suit splits 2-2 you could actually get three more winners. But the danger here is that if they **DON'T** split 2-2 and if North happens to win the third ♦ he might lead a ♠. And that might lead to disaster!

Instead, you allow for the possibility that ♦s may not split evenly and you make sure North (the Danger hand) doesn't get the lead. Win the ♥K in dummy. Play the ♦A, (which happens to draw the ♦J from South), then play a small ♦ and finesse with the ♦9. If South can win the trick then the ♦s have split 2-2 and your other 3 ♦s are good. Most importantly though, South cannot lead a ♠ without giving you a trick with your ♠K. If the finesse works, you make 5 ♦ tricks.

Sometimes good play is just visualizing what bad thing might happen.

Here the bad thing would be for North to get the lead and play a ♠. In this case you were able to avoid the bad situation by playing a suit differently than you might have done if there were no danger.